



New growth

Plants use sugar and starch as fuel. The fuel is transported to cells where it is burnt to release energy, which is used to grow new cells and repair old ones.



Wilting leaves

On warm, sunny days, plants lose lots of water from their leaves. If they lose too much their leaves collapse. This is called wilting. If plants don't get enough water their leaves will shrivel and die.

Fruit acts as a store of sugar and water.



Carrot plants store food in their roots.



Bulb



Storing food

Spare food is stored for future use. Plants such as hyacinths store food in the base of their leaves. This makes the leaves swell and form a bulb. The bulb survives the winter and in spring it sprouts new leaves.



Hands on



Place a stem of celery in a glass of water coloured with a few drops of food colouring. After two hours, cut across the stem. You will see tiny dots of colour showing the tubes that carry the water.